

Lead Tracking Workflow

n8n + Google Sheets — Status Processing & Update Guide

1. Workflow Goal

Read a lead from Google Sheets, allow only Pending leads to continue, lock/process the lead by changing its status to Processing, call the processing action, check whether processing succeeded, and finally update the Google Sheet with the final status.

2. Workflow Structure

Step	Node	Purpose
1	Manual Trigger	Starts the workflow manually.
2	READ_GetSpreadsheetRows	Reads the lead row from Google Sheets.
3	FILTER_PendingStatus	Allows the row only when lead_status = Pending.
4	LOCK_UpdateStatusProcessing	Matches the lead by lead_id and changes status to Processing.
5	ACTION_ProcessInvoice	Runs the processing action/API.
6	IF_ProcessSuccess	Checks whether the processing action succeeded.
7A	UPDATE_StatusComplete	Updates the same lead to Complete when successful.
7B	UPDATE_StatusFailed	Updates the same lead to Failed when processing fails.

3. Google Sheets Update Node

In the Google Sheets Update Row node, use **lead_id** as the matching column. This tells n8n which existing row must be updated.

Values to Update:

```
lead_id → {{$json.lead_id}}
name → {{$json.name}}
email → {{$json.email}}
lead_status → {{$json.lead_status}}
```

4. Important Execution Rule

If the node shows “No output data” before the previous nodes have run, that does not automatically mean the workflow is broken. Run the previous nodes first or execute the complete workflow so the current node receives input data.

5. Filter Configuration

The Pending filter should compare the incoming field **lead_status** with the text **Pending**. Example: lead_status is equal to Pending.

6. Successful Test Result

The successful execution shown during testing produced a row for lead L001 and changed the status from Pending to Processing. The lock/update node output also contained an execution identifier and

updated timestamp, confirming that the Google Sheets update step executed.

7. Final Verification Checklist

✓	Google Sheets credential is connected.
✓	Document is Operational Lead Tracker and sheet is Sheet1.
✓	Column to match on is lead_id.
✓	lead_id, name, email and lead_status are mapped.
✓	Pending filter passes the test lead.
✓	LOCK_UpdateStatusProcessing changes Pending → Processing.
✓	ACTION_ProcessInvoice runs after the lock node.
✓	IF_ProcessSuccess sends success to Complete and failure to Failed.
✓	Final Google Sheet row is verified after workflow execution.

Quick takeaway: first make sure the previous nodes produce input data; then the Update Row node can use `{{$.lead_id}}` to find the correct row and `{{$.lead_status}}` to write the new status.